developed by the Organization~/;

~I Reference is made to "General principles for ship reporting system and ship reporting requirements, including Guidelines for reporting incidents involving dangerous goods, harmful substances andlor marine pollutants" adopted by the Organization by resolution A.648(16). For ease of reference, see IMO publication "Provisions concerning the Reporting of Incidents Involving Harmful Substances under MAR POL 73/78".

W/6725D/EWP

RESOLUTION MEPC.54(32)

adopted on 6 March 1992

GUIDELINES FOR THE DEVELOPMENT OF SHIPBOARD

OIL POLLUTION EMERGENCY PLANSMEPC 32/20

ANNEX 4

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. 2 the list of authorities or persons to be contacted in the event of an oil pollution incident;

.3 a detailed description of the action to be taken immediately by persons on board to reduce or control the discharge of oil following the incident; and

.4 the procedures and point of contact on the ship for co-ordinating

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.3 a detailed description of the action to be taken immediately by persons on board to reduce or control the discharge of oil following the incident; and

.4 the procedures and point of contact on the ship for co-ordinating shipboard activities with national and local authorities in combating the pollution.

2.3 The coastal State report: Article 8 and Protocol I of the Convention require that the nearest coastal State be notified of actual or probable discharges. The intent of this requirement is to ensure that coastal States are informed without delay, of any incident giving rise to pollution, or threat of pollution, of the marine environment, as well as of assistance and salvage measures, so that appropriate action may be taken.

2.3.1 When required: The Plan should provide clear, concise guidance to enable the master to determine when a report to the coastal State is required.

2.3.1.1 Actual discharge: A report to the nearest coastal State is required whenever there is:

. 1 a discharge of oil, resulting from damage to the ship or its equipment, or for the purpose of securing the safety of a ship or saving life at sea; or

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whenever there is:

. 1 a discharge of oil, resulting from damage to the ship or its equipment, or for the purpose of securing the safety of a ship

or saving life at sea; or
.2 a discharge during the operation of the ship of oil in excess of the quantity or instantaneous rate permitted under the present Convention.
2.3.1.2 Probable discharge: The Plan should give the master guidance to evaluate a situation which, though not involving an actual discharge, would qualify as a probable discharge and thus require a report. In jUdging whether there is such a probability and whether the report should be made, the following factors, as a minimwn, should be taken into account:
.1 the nature of the damage, failure or breakdown of the ship, machinery or equipment;
. 2 ship location and proximity to land or other navigational hazards;
. 3 weather, tide, current and sea state; and
.4 traffic density.
2.3.1.2.1 It is impracticable to lay down precise definitions of all types of situations involving probable discharge which would warrant an obligation to report. As a general guideline, the master should make a report in cases of:
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2.3.1.2.1 It is impracticable to lay down precise definitions of all types of situations involving probable discharge which would warrant an obligation to report. As a general guideline, the master should make a report in cases of:
. 1 damage, failure or breakdown which affects the safety of ships; examples of such situations are collision, grounding, fire, explosion, structural failure, flooding, cargo shifting; and

.2 failure or breakdown of machinery or equipment which results in impairment of the safety of navigation: examples of such incidents are failure or breakdown of steering gear, propulsion, electrical generating system, essential shipborne navigational aids.
2.3.2 Information required: The Plan must specify, in appropriate detail, tbe procedure for making the initial report to the coastal State. The Organization's guidelines in resolution A.648(16) provide necessary detail for the Plan writer. The Plan should include a prepared message form, an example
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tbe procedure for making the initial report to the coastal State. The Organization's guidelines in resolution A.648(16) provide necessary detail for the Plan writer. The Plan should include a prepared message form, an example
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